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Part of  Knowledgepool

Business and Administration

Hints and Tips

Unit 2



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Hints and Tips Unit 2

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit two: Principles of providing administrative services

Section 1 - Understand how to make and receive telephone calls

Q1. Complete the table below with descriptions of at least two different features of a telephone system and how / when they would be used

Please make sure you complete every section of the table. Describe each of the features in the left hand column then describe how and when the feature would be used, use examples to support your answer.

Q2. Prepare a brief report advising people on:

- How to follow organisational procedures when making and receiving telephone calls
- The purpose of giving a positive image of yourself and your organisation when making and receiving telephone calls.

When answering the phone, should it be answered within a certain number of rings? How should you greet people when you answer the phone? Before making a call, is there any preparation that you need to do? An example procedure for answering the telephone can be found at <http://sbinfocanada.about.com/cs/management/qt/telephonetips.htm>.

Section 2 - Understand how to handle mail

Q1. Explain the purpose of correctly receiving, checking and sorting mail and packages (both incoming and outgoing).

Why is it important that people receive mail on time? What could the consequences be if mail was lost or late (both incoming and outgoing mail)?

Q2. Complete the table below with the following information:

- At least two examples of internal mail services that are available to organisations
- At least two examples of external mail services that are available to organisations.

You must provide two examples of internal mail services and two examples of external mail services. Please make sure you complete every section of the table.

Q3. Describe two methods that you can use to calculate postage charges for mail and / or packages.

Give a description of two different methods which you can use to calculate postage charges.

Section 3 – Using different types of office equipment

Q1. Describe the main types of equipment found in offices and how they are used. Include examples of at least three different types of office equipment.

Give a description of at least three different types of office equipment. How are they used in the office?

Q2. Explain the purpose of following manufacturer's instructions when using equipment.

You need to consider the four areas that are mentioned in the course materials when answering this question and refer to them in your answer.

Q3. Explain the purpose of keeping equipment clean, hygienic and ready for the next user.

Give reasons why it is important to keep equipment clean, hygienic and ready for the next user.

Section 4 – Minimising waste at work

Q1. Explain why waste should be kept to a minimum in a business environment.

The DEFRA website www.defra.gov.uk contains some useful information on the advantages of good waste management for businesses.

Q2. Identify at least two main causes of waste in a business environment.

List two causes of waste. We looked at common causes of waste on page 6 of the course materials.

Q3. How can you keep waste to a minimum in a business environment? Describe at least two ways of doing this.

For this question you need to give a full description of how waste can be minimised within a business. Again, the DEFRA website gives useful information that supports the learning materials.

Section 5 – Making arrangements for meetings

Q1. Complete the table below listing at least two different types of meetings and describing the main features of each type of meeting.

Identify two different types of meeting and then provide a description of the main features of each type of meeting. Think about the focus of the meeting, who might be involved in the meeting and is the meeting formal or informal.

Q2. When arranging a meeting:

- What sources and types of information are typically needed?
- How should meetings be arranged?

This question is in two parts. Break your answer down into the two sections of the question. What information, equipment and facilities are required to hold a meeting? If you were asked to arrange a meeting for a group of people, how would you arrange the meeting?

Section 6 – Organising travel and accommodation

Q1. Explain the purpose of confirming instructions and requirements for business travel and accommodation.

What could go wrong if you didn't have the right information when arranging travel and accommodation?

Q2. Complete the table below with an outline of the main types of business travel and accommodation arrangements that may need to be made and the procedures that should be followed when doing this.

You need to consider the different modes of transport people can use when travelling for work and also where they would stay overnight, when away on business. When making these arrangements, think about what needs to be considered for each one.

Q3. Explain the purpose of keeping records of travel/accommodation arrangements in a business environment.

Why are accurate records of travel costs useful to a business? Consider the four areas mentioned in the course materials.

Section 7 – Diary management procedures

Q1. Briefly explain the purpose of using a diary system to plan activities at work. Give at least two reasons.

Why is it useful to keep a diary of what you are planning to do? If you didn't keep a diary what could the possible consequences be?

Q2. Identify the information needed to maintain a diary system in the workplace.

What information would you include in a diary in order to get the most use from it? Think of the '5 Ws'.

Section 8 – Delivering effective customer service

Q1. What are the differences between internal and external customers in a business environment?

Briefly outline or describe what internal customers and external customers are and identify the differences between them.

Q2. Explain why customer service should meet or exceed customer expectations. Include at least three reasons in your answer.

Why is it important that organisations have happy customers? You need to give three reasons. As well as the course materials, the Institute of Customer Service; <http://www.instituteofcustomerservice.com/> - has some useful information about customer service.

Q3. Explain the importance of building positive relationships with customers. Outline two ways in which this can be achieved.

You need to explain how you can make customers happy. Would meeting their expectations make them happy? As well as the course materials, the Institute of Customer Service <http://www.instituteofcustomerservice.com> - has useful information on this subject.

Q4. How do customers demonstrate their own needs and expectations?

How do customers give feedback on a company's level of service? Is it verbally? Is it by completing surveys?

Section 9 – Reception services and procedures

Q1. What is the purpose of the receptionist role as the first point of contact in a business environment?

You need to include what the purpose of the receptionist is within a company. Include the different duties a receptionist will carry out in your answer.

Q2. Describe how a receptionist can present a positive image of themselves and the organisation and explain why this is important.

It is important that the receptionist gives a positive impression of themselves as they are often the first point of contact people will have with an organisation. How does a receptionist create a positive impression? Does appearance, communication (both verbal and non-verbal), behaviour and professionalism make a difference?

Q3. In relation to your own organisation (or one that you are familiar with), explain what must be done when carrying out entry, departure, security and confidentiality procedures in a reception area.

Provide an account of what must be done when carrying out each of the procedures listed.